

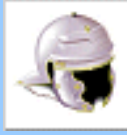
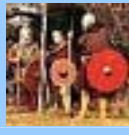
Understanding U.K. & Ireland

Understanding U.K

Chapter Ten Geography and History

B. History

British History Timeline

Celts	Romans	Saxons	Vikings	Normans	Tudors	Victorians	WW II
							
500 BC	AD 43	450	793	1066	1485	1837	1939+

Brief History of Britain

Thousands of years ago, Great Britain was joined to Europe and was covered with ice. About 15,000 years ago, the weather became warmer. The ice melted and the sea level rose. Great Britain became an island about 8000 years ago.

Little is known about people inhabiting the British Isles in the Pre-Celtic period (before 800 BC).

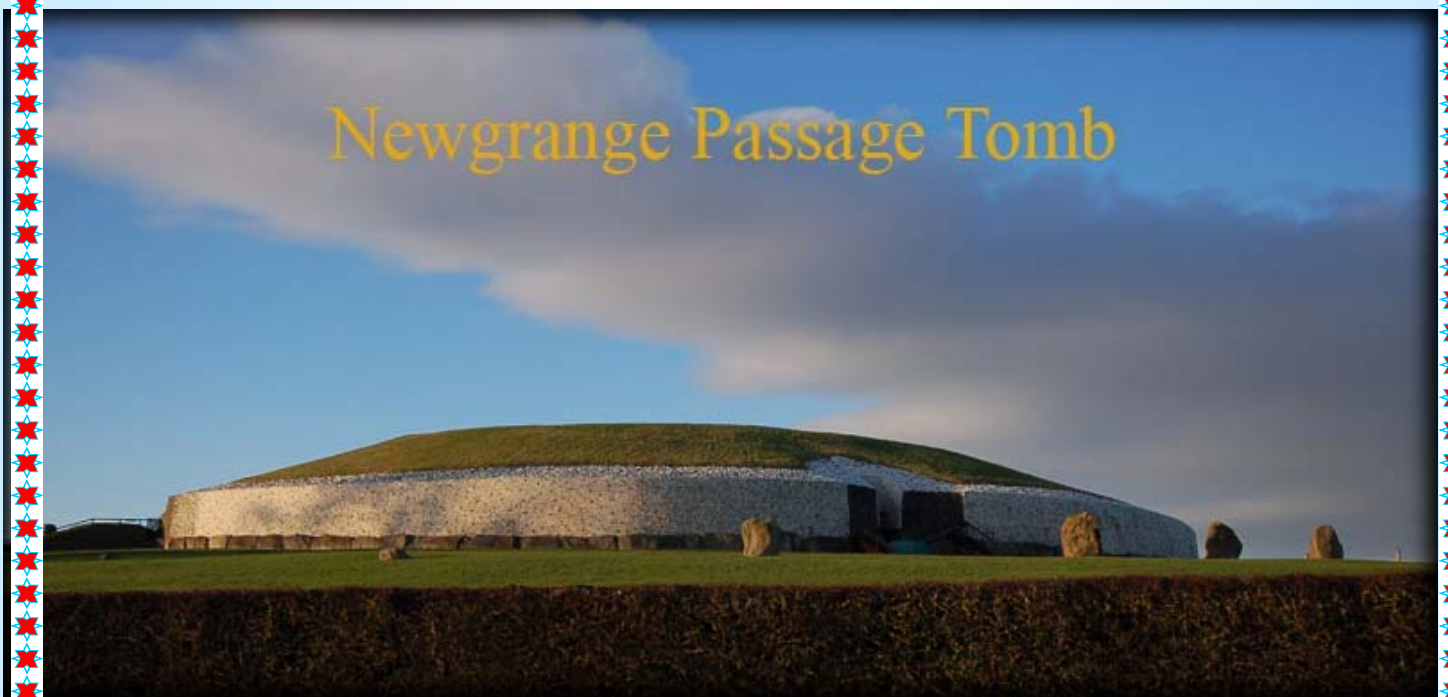
Some monuments built by them have been preserved such as Stonehenge, erected some time before 1000 BC or Newgrange monument – it is the tomb.



Stonehenge is a prehistoric monument located in the English county of Wiltshire. Archaeologists had believed that the iconic stone monument was erected around 2500 BC. However one recent theory has suggested that the first stones were not erected until 2400-2200 BC, whilst another suggests that blue stones may have been erected at the site as early as 3000 BC.



An aerial view of Stonehenge, Wiltshire—5100-3100 BCE



Newgrange

1. The Celts

The first Celtic tribes, the Goidels or Gales are believed to have come to the British Isles between 800 & 700 BC. Two centuries later they were followed by the Brythons or ancient Britons after whom the country was called Britain.

The word Celt comes from the Greek word, Keltoi, meaning barbarians. No-one called the people living in Britain during the Iron Age Celts until the eighteenth century. In fact the Romans called these people Britons, not Celts.

The Celts were the first master of Europe who settled in Britain in about 500 B.C.





The Celts were a warlike people who tended to have battles that frequently devolved into individual combats; where the victor

would cut off the head of the loser and display it on a pole outside his hut. From around 750 BC to 12 BC, the Celts were the most powerful people in central and northern Europe and Northwest Europe was dominated by three main Celtic groups:

- the Gauls
- the Britons
- the Gaels

The Celts were ancestors of the Scots, the Irish and the Welsh, and their languages are the basis of Welsh and Gaelic.

Celtic civilization in Britain was most advanced in the south and southeast. The Celts lived both



in villages and in OPPIDA (towns); their townspeople knew the concept of division of labor. Some Celtic peoples had a coinage.

Celtic society was divided into three main classes: the warrior aristocracy, the **Druids** who were the religious leaders and at the same time teachers. Women were also regarded highly amongst the Celts, which was unusual during ancient times, some even becoming tribal leaders.

Celtic Britain was far from united. There was no union among the tribes, and wars were frequent. By the time of Julius Caesar, Celtic peoples have dominated the British islands.



2. Roman Britain (55BC-410AD)



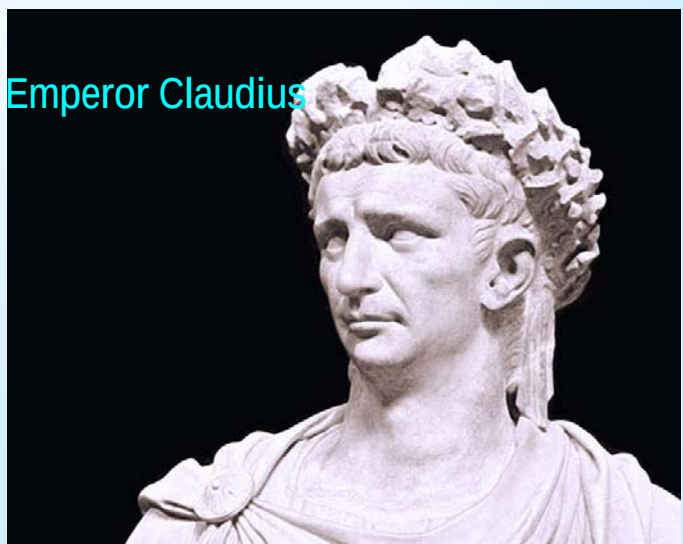
For several centuries, immediately after the time of Christ, the people of Britain found themselves if not the slaves then certainly the servants of one of the mightiest empires the world has ever seen - the empire of Rome.

British recorded history begins with the Roman invasion. The first Roman invasion was led by Julius Caesar in 55 BC. But Britain was not conquered until some 90 years later, under Emperor Claudius, in 43 AD. For nearly 400 years, Britain was under the Roman occupation.

General Julius Caesar



Emperor Claudius



The Romans brought the Britons into great contact with Roman civilization. One of the greatest achievements of the Roman Empire was its system of roads. They constructed a network of roads between the large towns. Many of them are still in use now because of their remarkable solidity. They also allowed the movement of agricultural products from farm to market. The Roman built many towns, roads, baths, temples, amphitheaters and beautiful villas and buildings. They also brought to Britain the new religion, Christianity, which had thoroughly replaced the old Celtic gods by the close of the 4th Century, but Romanization was not successful in other areas. Apart from the villas and fortified settlements, the great mass of the British people did not seem to have become Romanized and people did not adopt the Latin language, so Latin did not displace Celtic.

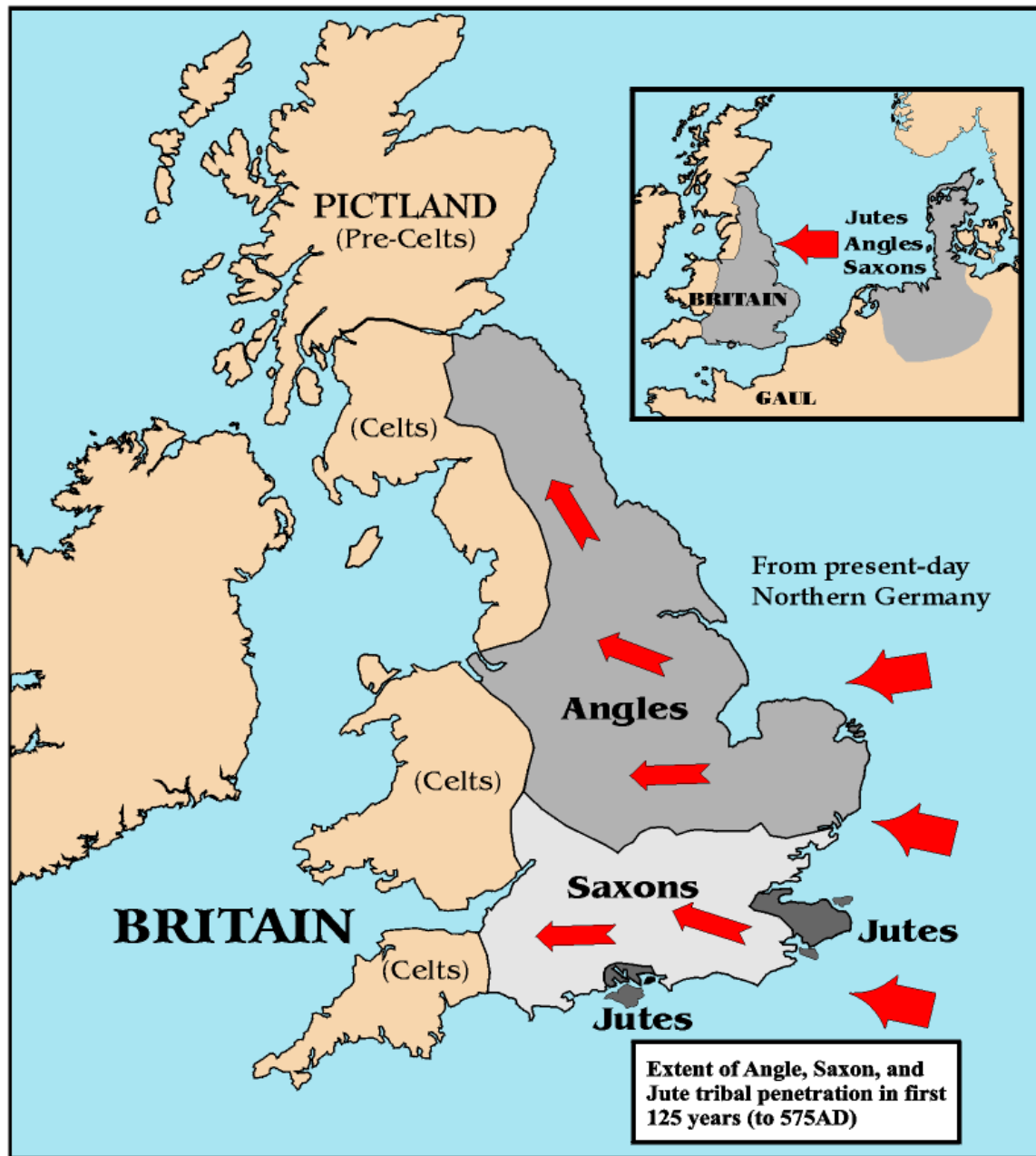
3. The Angle-Saxon Conquest (446-871)

Germanic tribes from northwestern Europe began to raid Roman-occupied Britain in the third century, carrying away grain, cattle, and other valuables. In the mid-5th century, not long after Roman troops were withdrawn from Britain, a new wave of invaders, the three Teutonic tribes — Jutes, Saxons, and Angles, collectively known as the Anglo-Saxons — came to Britain across the North Sea in search of land for settlement. According to tradition, the first important settlement was made about 449 on Britain's eastern coast by the Jutes, who had fished and farmed in Jutland. Then came the Saxons, users of the short-sword from northern Germany, from the end of the 5th century to the beginning of the 6th century. In the second half of the 6th century, the Angles, also from northern Germany, arrived.



ANGLE, SAXON, JUTE

Starting 449 A.D.



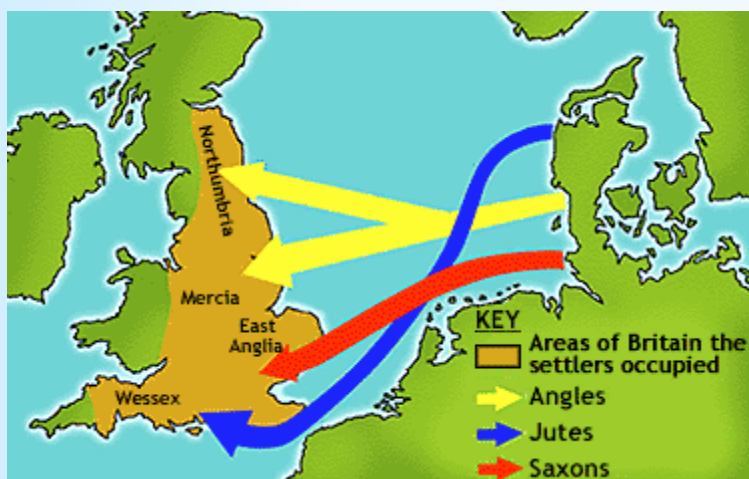
Anglo-Saxon Conquest of Britain

Unlike the Romans who only took 35 years to conquer all of Britain except the (Scottish) Highlands, the Angles, Saxons, and Jutes fought for more than two centuries before they controlled even half of the island. It was a bitter struggle, but the Germanic tribes were thorough. For nearly two centuries, the invaders penetrated the island by way of its inland rivers, ravaging as they advanced. Roman civilization was destroyed; its language, religion, and customs disappeared. Most of the native Britons were killed, enslaved, or driven into Wales and to Brittany (in France).

About 613 the Anglo-Saxon conquest of central Britain was completed. Anglo-Saxon England was divided into a number of small kingdoms. The Jutes occupied the region called Kent, between the Thames River and the Strait of Dover. The Saxons settled to the south and west of London. Their major kingdoms were Sussex, Essex, and Wessex. The Angles, who

gave their name to the country, settled in the eastern coast from the territory of the Saxons northward into the Scottish lowlands. They formed the kingdoms of East Anglia, Mercia, and Northumbria.

Constant conflict followed during the four centuries after the conquest of Britain. The Anglo-Saxons warred among themselves, against the Welsh (Britons in Wales), and later against Danish and Norwegian invaders (the Vikings). The more powerful Anglo-Saxon kingdoms absorbed their weaker neighbors. From the seven major kingdoms that developed during the invasions, three dominant states emerged — Northumbria, Mercia, and Wessex.



A map showing the various migration routes taken by Germanic tribes from the 5th and 11th centuries

Anglo-Saxon domination lasted for four centuries, though it did not include Scotland, where the Picts and the Scots established a separate kingdom. The Anglo Saxon period can be characterised as a period of transition from a tribal to feudal organisation of society.

Although barbarians, the Anglo-Saxons were more advanced than the Britons had been before the Roman occupation. The Anglo-Saxons laid the foundations of the English state. They divided the country into shires, with shire courts and shire reeves, or sheriffs, responsible for administering law. They devised an effective farming system which was in use to the 18th century. Finally, they created the Witan, (council or meeting of the wise-men) to advise the king, the basis of the Council which still exists today.



They brought to Britain their own Teutonic religion, which was dominant over Christianity until the end of the 6th century, when In 597 Saint Augustine, sent by Pope Gregory I, arrived in Kent to convert the people of the British Isles to Christianity. By the end of the seventh century, missionaries had converted all of England and monasteries were established and became centers of learning. Christianity played an important role in civilizing the Anglo-Saxons.

4. Viking and Danish invasions (793-1066)



From the 8th century the Anglo-Saxons had to face Scandinavian invaders – the Danes and the Norsemen (meaning 'people from the North'), sometimes referred to as Vikings – who came across the North Sea, just as the Anglo-Saxons had done 400 years earlier, and occupied parts of Britain.

Vikings were great travelers and sailed in their long boats all over Europe and the Atlantic Ocean, where they traded, raided, and often settled. They were also farmers, fishermen, trappers and traders. Viking craftsmen made beautiful objects out of wood, metal and bone; Viking women were skilful weavers, produced fine, warm textiles.



A model of a Viking longboat

The reason for most Vikings to sail overseas was simply searching for better land for their farms. At home their land was not very good for farming. Norway was very hilly, Sweden was covered in forests, and Denmark had a lot of sandy land.

Where did the Vikings come from?



The Scandinavian invasions continued till the 11th century, when they were defeated at sea by Alfred the Great (849-899), king of Wessex and the founder of the British navy. The Vikings settled peacefully in an area of Britain which became known as **Danelaw** and eventually the Vikings were assimilated.

Alfred the Great was noted for resisting the Danes and uniting the various English kingdoms under one rule. "The father of the British navy and a promoter of learning and legal system as well as a skillful military leader and administrator, Alfred is the only English king to be labeled "the Great."



Map showing the Dane law



King Alfred the Great

5. The Norman Conquest (1066)

The Norman conquest of England began in 1066.

In January 1066, King Edward, the last Saxon king, died childless. He had promised to leave the English throne to his cousin William, but he chose Harold, his wife's brother as king. So William led his army to invade the Kingdom of England. In October 1066, during the important battle of Hastings, William of Normandy's army of some 12,000 horse and 20,000 foot defeated King Harold Godwinson's 25,000 Saxons on Senlac Hill near Hastings. King Harold was killed. He is one of only two Kings of England to have died in battle (the other being Richard III). On Christmas Day, William was crowned king of England. This resulted in Norman control of England, which was firmly established during the next few years.

The Norman Conquest of 1066 was important

event in English history. It brought about many consequences.

William confiscated almost all the land and gave it to his Norman followers. He replaced the weak Saxon rule with a strong Norman government. So the feudal system was completely established in England. Relations with the Continent were opened, and civilization and commerce were extended. Norman-French culture, language, manners, and architecture were introduced. The church was brought into closer connection with Rome, and the church courts were separated from the civil courts.

The Norman Conquest also had important consequences for the rest of the British Isles, paving the way for further Norman invasions in Wales and Ireland, and the extensive penetration of the aristocracy of Scotland by Norman and other French-speaking families.



The route of William the Conqueror



The Battle of Hastings, 1066

the Anglo-Saxons lost and the Normans won due to their overall superiority

6. The Plantagenet's (1154-1458) and Tudors (1485 -1603)

From 1154 to 1547 much of English history was shaped by the shifting alliances of the Plantagenet and Tudor kings. Royal succession was by no means assured during this period of conflict and disease—nearly half the population was killed by the Black Death in 1348-49. International relations were dominated by struggle with France, including the Hundred Years War (1337-1453). In domestic politics, Wales was subjugated by 1288, and Scottish independence was recognized in 1314, when English forces were defeated by Robert Bruce at the Battle of Bannockburn.

The Wars of the Roses (battles between the House of Lancaster, symbolized by the red rose, and that of York, symbolized by the white) in the period from 1455 to 1485 illustrated that those who could obtain the greatest military

power from a majority of rival barons were able to claim the throne. Henry Tudor, descendant of Duke of Lancaster won victory of the Wars of the Roses in 1485 and put the country under the rule of the Tudors. The Tudor Period (1485 -1603) was a turning point in English history. England became one of the leading powers. The two famous rulers of the House of Tudor were **Henry VIII** (28 June 1491–28 January 1547) and **Elisabeth I** (7 September 1533–24 March 1603).



Britain's most famous king was Henry VIII(1509-1547), remembered not only for his six wives (two of whom he had beheaded), but also for bringing about the Reformation. He established the Church of England as the national church of the country, and made himself the supreme head of the Church of England. As a result of the Reformation, England became a Protestant country, rather than a Catholic one.

Henry VIII's reform stressed the power of the monarch and certainly strengthened Henry's position; Parliament had never done such a long and important piece of work before, its importance grew as a result. Henry also took advantage of a growing resentment for the excessive wealth and privilege of the Church; thus he was able to seize enough monastic lands and property to finance his rule. He created the Royal Navy, which became the basis of future British sea power.

Henry's quarrel with the Church was centered on the Pope's refusal to annul his marriage with Catherine of Aragon, who could not give him a male heir to the throne.



Portrait of Henry VIII

Portrait of Henry VIII's
six wives



The Elizabethan Age (1558–1603)



Queen Elizabeth I

Under Elizabeth I, daughter of Henry VIII and Anne Boleyn, England entered a Golden Age. Among the events of the Elizabethan Age were the defeat of the Spanish Armada in 1588, Sir Walter Raleigh's discovery of tobacco in Virginia, and Sir Francis Drake's circumnavigation of the world. The Elizabethan age saw the flourishing of English poetry, music and literature and produced the world's greatest playwright

William Shakespeare. It was also the end of the period when England was a separate realm before its royal union with Scotland.

The Elizabethan Age is viewed so highly because of the contrasts with the periods before and after. It was a brief period of largely internal peace between the English Reformation and the battles between Protestants and Catholics and the battles between parliament and the monarchy that engulfed the seventeenth century. The Protestant/Catholic divide was settled, for a time, by the Elizabethan Religious Settlement, and parliament was not yet strong enough to challenge royal absolutism. England was also well-off compared to the other nations of Europe and the century's long conflict between France and England was largely suspended for most of Elizabeth's reign.

7. The Stuarts (1603–1714)

The Stuart period of British history usually refers to the period between 1603 and 1714. After the death of Elizabeth, the “Virgin Queen” who left no male heir, the throne was occupied by James VI of Scotland; James inaugurated the Stuart dynasty and ruled the kingdom of England, Scotland, and Ireland for 22 years, from 1603 to 1625, often using the title King of Great Britain, until his death at the age of 58. The period ended with Queen Anne and the accession of George I from the House of Hanover.

Conflict between the Crown and Parliament characterized the Stuart period. James I would have preferred to have no Parliament at all, since he was a firm believer in the Divine Right of Kings, which was the belief that kings received their power from God and thus could not be deposed. James I wore the insignia of the Order of the Garter in 1621





King Charles I

His Successor Charles I dissolved Parliament and introduced a period of absolute rule which lasted eleven years. The result of the conflict was Civil War (1642-1649), also called the Puritan Revolution. The Civil War ended with the Parliamentary victory. Charles I was condemned to death and his son, Charles II was exiled.

Beheading the King



The English Civil War overthrew feudal system in England and led to the replacement of English monarchy first with the Commonwealth of England (1649–53), and then with a Protectorate (1653–59), under Oliver

Cromwell's personal rule. It also shook the foundation of the feudal rule in Europe. Under the rule of Oliver Cromwell, a period of republicanism followed, but after Cromwell's death in 1658, the monarchy was restored and prospered under Charles II, the late King's son who was asked to return from his exile in France as the king. This was called the Restoration.



Oliver Cromwell (April 25, 1599 - September 3, 1658) was an English military and political leader best known for his involvement in making England into a republican Commonwealth and for his later role as Lord Protector of England, Scotland, and Ireland. After the execution of King Charles I in 1649, Cromwell dominated the short-lived Commonwealth of England, conquered Ireland and Scotland, and ruled as Lord Protector from 1653 until his death in 1658.

The Glorious Revolution of 1688



Left: King Charles II of England, Ireland and Scotland, Reign 29 May 1660–6 February 1685 ; Right: King James II, Reign 1685~1688

In 1685 Charles II died and was succeeded by his brother James II, who was a Catholic king in a country that was thoroughly Protestant and wanted nothing to do with the Pope in Rome. James wanted to change the State religion if England back to Catholicism. He is best known for his belief in absolute monarchy and his attempts to create religious liberty for his subjects. Both of these went against the wishes of the English Parliament and of most of his

subjects. So the English politicians rejected James II, and appealed to a Protestant king, the Dutch stadtholder William of Orange, to invade and take the English throne. William landed in England in 1688 and takeover was relatively smooth, with no bloodshed, nor any execution of the king. This was known as the "Glorious Revolution". It was indeed a revolution and paved the way for Parliament's dominance over the Crown. James was then replaced not by his Catholic son, James Francis Edward, but by his Protestant daughter Mary II and his son-in-law William III, who became joint rulers in 1689. Authority was simplified when Mary's death in 1694 left William the sole monarch.





James's nephew and son-in-law, William, was invited to "save the Protestant religion"

The overthrow of James II in 1688 was the second time in the 17th century that a Stuart king had lost his crown. However, unlike Charles I, his father, James II did not lose his head as well.

James II made one serious attempt to recover his crowns when he landed in Ireland in 1689, but, after the defeat of the Jacobite forces by the Williamite forces at the Battle of the Boyne in the summer of 1690, James returned to France. He lived out the rest of his life under the protection of his cousin and ally, King Louis XIV.

The Glorious Revolution of 1688 is the greatest landmark in the history of England. This revolution is so called because it achieved its objective without any bloodshed. The struggle between the King and the Parliament ended in victory for the people (i.e. the representative of the people - the parliament). It marks the end of absolutism, never since has the monarch held absolute power, and the beginning of modern English parliamentary democracy. The Bill of Rights has become one of the most important documents in the political history of Britain. The deposition of the Roman Catholic James II ended any chance of Catholicism

becoming re-established in England, and also led to limited toleration for nonconformist Protestants—it would be some time before they had full political rights. For Catholics, however, it was disastrous both socially and politically. Catholics were denied the right to vote and sit in the Westminster Parliament for over 100 years afterwards. They were also denied commissions in the army and the monarch was forbidden to be Catholic or marry a Catholic, thus ensuring the Protestant succession.

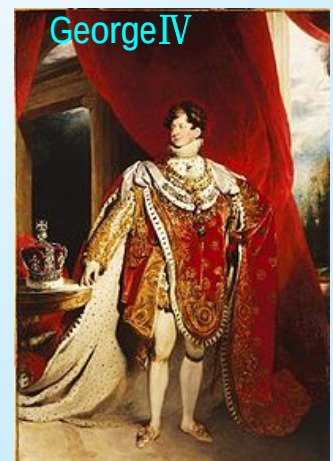
8. Georgian (1714 to 1830) & Victorian Age (1837-1901)

England and Scotland were united in 1707 by the Act of Union. The House of Hanover succeeded the House of Stuart as monarchs of Great Britain and Ireland in 1714 and held that office until the death of Victoria in 1901. George I of Hanover was the first British monarch of the House of Hanover and Queen Victoria was the

last. The dynasty provided six British monarchs:

- George I (r.1714-1727)
- George II (r.1727-1760)
- George III (r.1760-1820)
- George IV (r.1820-1830)
- William IV (r.1830-1837)
- Victoria (r.1837-1901).

The Georgian era is normally defined as including the reigns of the kings George I, George II, George III and George IV, i.e. covering the period from 1714 to 1830, (with the sub-period of the Regency, defined by the Regency of George IV as Prince of Wales during the illness of his father George III). Sometimes the reign of William IV (1830 to 1837) is also included.



During George I's reign the powers of the monarchy diminished and Britain began a transition to the modern system of cabinet government led by a prime minister. Towards the end of his reign, actual power was held by Sir Robert Walpole, Great Britain's first actual prime minister. George died in 1727 on a trip to his native Hanover, where he was buried.

The Victorian Age comprised the second half of the 19th century and is generally agreed to stretch through the reign of Queen Victoria from June 1837 until her death on the 22nd of January 1901. It was preceded by the Georgian era and succeeded by the Edwardian period.



Queen Victoria was the only child of Edward Duke of Kent, the granddaughter of George III and was a descendant of most major European royal houses. At age eighteen Victoria ascended the English throne in June of 1837 following the

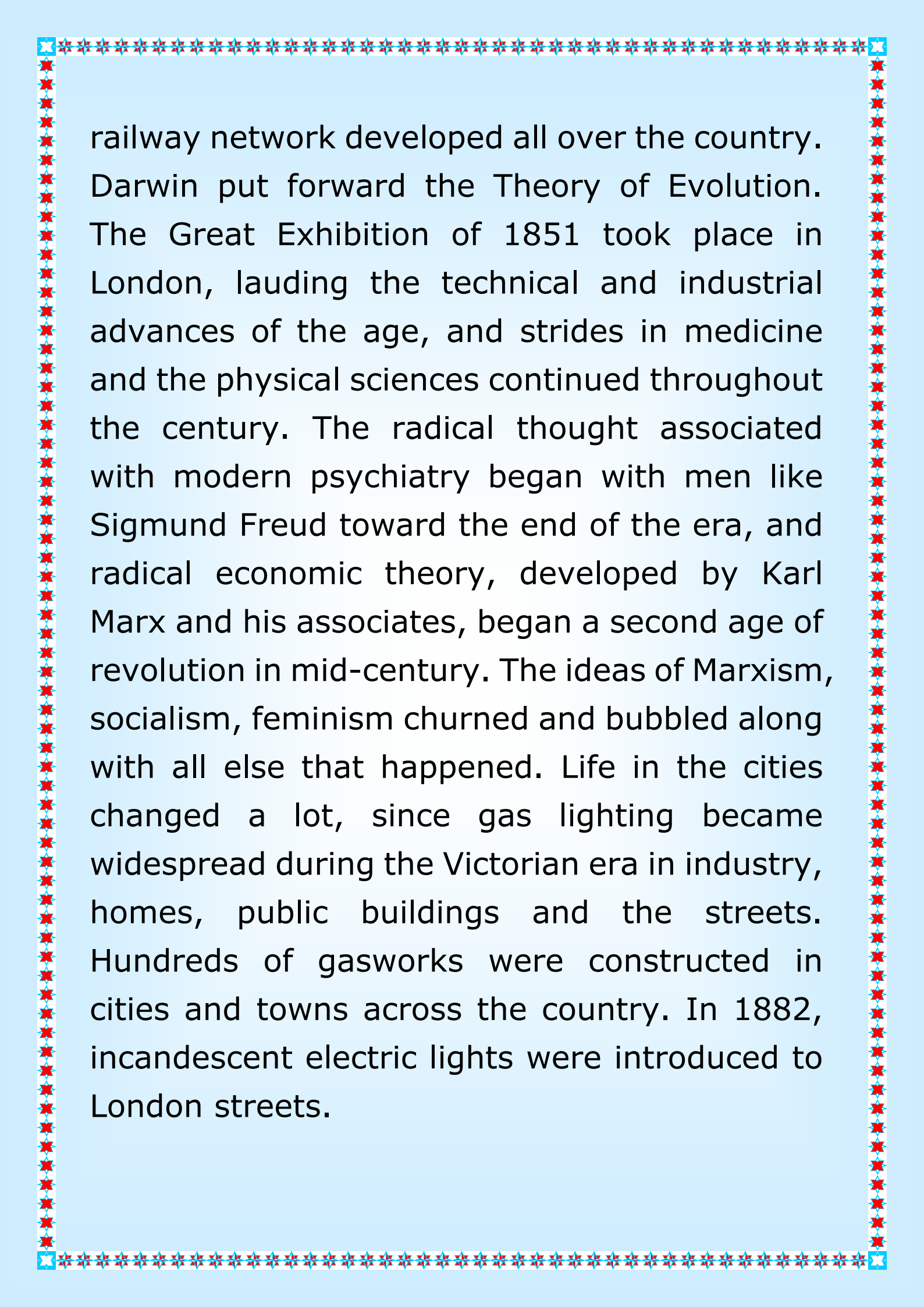
death of her uncle King William IV. In 1840 she married her first cousin Albert. She arranged marriages for her children and grandchildren across the continent, tying Europe together; this earned her the nickname "the grandmother of Europe."



An 1883 painting of Queen Victoria (1819 - 1901). Behind the queen is a portrait of her deceased consort, Prince Albert. The box beside her is labeled 'First Lord of the Treasury'.

The Victorian Age was a period in which Britain became the strongest world power: besides being the greatest financial and commercial power, the greatest sea power and the greatest colonial power and is often characterized as a long period of peace and prosperity for the British people, as profits gained from the overseas British Empire, as well as from industrial improvements at home allowed an educated middle class to develop. It was a tremendously exciting era when many artistic styles, literary schools, as well as, social, political and religious movements flourished. It was a time of prosperity, broad imperial expansion, and great political reform.

The Victorian Age was also a time of tremendous scientific progress and ideas. The Industrial Revolution had already occurred, but it was during this period that the full effects of industrialization made themselves felt, leading to the mass consumer society of the 20th century. This is also the period when the



railway network developed all over the country. Darwin put forward the Theory of Evolution. The Great Exhibition of 1851 took place in London, lauding the technical and industrial advances of the age, and strides in medicine and the physical sciences continued throughout the century. The radical thought associated with modern psychiatry began with men like Sigmund Freud toward the end of the era, and radical economic theory, developed by Karl Marx and his associates, began a second age of revolution in mid-century. The ideas of Marxism, socialism, feminism churned and bubbled along with all else that happened. Life in the cities changed a lot, since gas lighting became widespread during the Victorian era in industry, homes, public buildings and the streets. Hundreds of gasworks were constructed in cities and towns across the country. In 1882, incandescent electric lights were introduced to London streets.

During the early part of the era, the House of Commons was headed by the two parties, the Whigs and the Tories. From the late 1850s onwards, the Whigs became the Liberals; the Tories became the Conservatives. These parties were led by many prominent statesmen.

Without a doubt, The Victorian Age was an extraordinarily complex age, which has sometimes been called the Second English Renaissance. It is, however, also the beginning of Modern Times.

Queen Victoria's nearly 64-year reign (1837-1901) was the longest in British history, and is foreseeably likely to be exceeded only if the present monarch (Queen Elizabeth II) remains on the throne to 2017. Queen Victoria was succeeded by her eldest son, the Prince of Wales, who reigned as King Edward VII. Today it is her great-great granddaughter that rules

the United Kingdom, and Elizabeth's consort, Philip, is Victoria's great-great grandson.

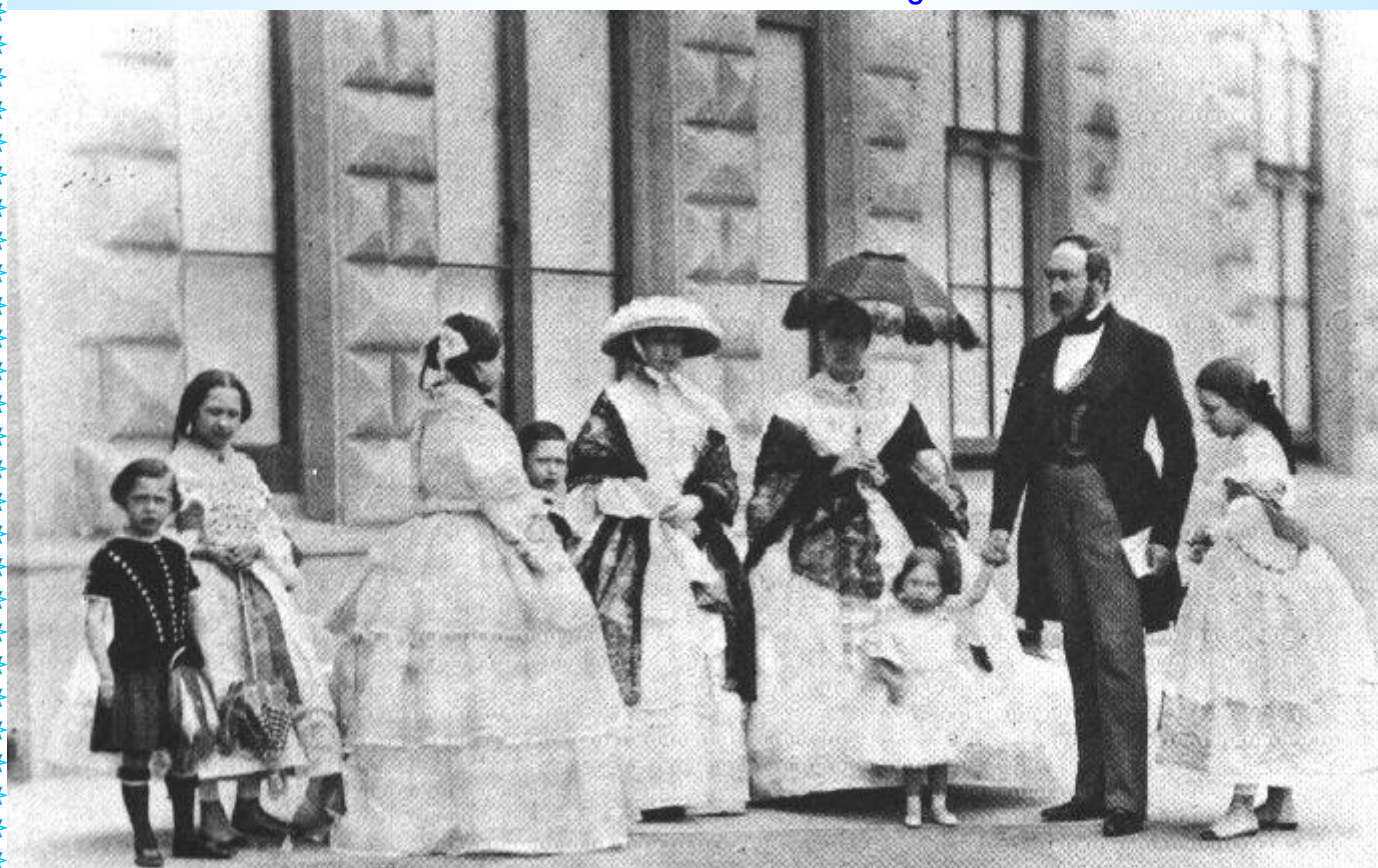


Queen Victoria and Prince Albert

One would imagine that it would have been hard for Prince Albert, a man who was sidelined almost all life, to be married to Victoria, the Queen of England. But history says it wasn't so. The couple, first cousins who married at a very young age, was very much in love and had nine children. The Queen often relied on her husband for advice in matters of state, especially in diplomacy. They never let power, the throne or title to disrupt their marriage. His sudden death at age 42 devastated the Queen and she went into lengthy seclusion after his death in 1861. This decreased her popularity and motivated a Republican movement against the Crown. Victoria's recognition as empress of India, and her Diamond Jubilee in 1887 put her back in her subjects favor and increased the prestige of the monarchy. Victoria continued to reign until the later part of 1900, when her health began to fail and she retired to Osbourne, her seaside home on the Isle of Wight. There an era ended when the Queen died on Jan. 22, 1901.



1854: Queen Victoria and Prince Albert in a re-enactment of their marriage ceremony of 1840. Prince Albert is in military uniform and is wearing his medals.



Updated Photo of Queen Victoria and Prince Albert with their children



Queen Victoria was responsible for starting the tradition of brides wearing white at their wedding. Yet after her beloved Prince Albert died, Queen Victoria spent much of her life cloaked in widow's black.



An era ended when the Queen died on Jan. 22, 1901. After a state funeral Victoria was buried beside her beloved Albert at Frogmore.

The Industrial Revolution (1760 – 1850)

The Industrial Revolution refers to the mechanization of industry and the consequent changes in social and economic organization in Britain in the late 18th and early 19th centuries. It started with the mechanization of the textile industries, the development of iron-making techniques and the increased use of refined coal. The onset of the Industrial Revolution marked a major turning point in human history; it forever transformed the way people live and work in most parts of the world.

Before the Industrial Revolution, most people lived by farming. There was little industry. Any manufacturing was done in homes or in small workshops close to home. People used craft skills, such as weaving or woodworking, to produce goods for their families or to sell in towns. The Industrial Revolution took production out of homes and workshops and into big factories. People moved from the countryside into industrial cities. New roads,

canals, railroads, and steamships were built to carry factory-made goods and the raw materials to make them. The British government was eager to increase the country's income from trade, and it encouraged industry. Business people also hoped to make more money. They saw opportunities to profit from new inventions and new ways of making goods.

The invention of the steam engine was an important step in the Industrial Revolution. Steam engines powered factories and drove the trains that carried goods over long distances. The first big factories in Britain grew up around the textile industry. For centuries, spinning yarn and weaving cloth was done mostly by hand. British business owners realized they could profit more by increasing production. They developed new machines that could weave cloth, and they built large, new factories to hold them. Before long, Britain was

supplying cloth to countries throughout the world.

Huge factories were also built near sources of iron, coal, and water. Three regions of Britain—northern England, central England, and central Scotland—became industrial zones and workers moved to big new industrial cities such as Birmingham, Manchester, Newcastle on Tyne, and Glasgow as more and more factories opened there.

From the 18th century, new agricultural machines began to replace more and more of the traditional farming implements that had been used for centuries. The seed drill was an important development, as was the cast-iron plough patented by Robert Ransome in 1803. Such inventions helped fuel the immense increase of farm productivity in Britain's Agricultural Revolution, which both stimulated and benefited from the Industrial Revolution. Improvements in crop rotation and fertilizers

were as important to this process as machinery. By about 1800, the new inventions and work techniques in Britain spread to Europe and North America. A second phase of the Industrial Revolution began about 1850. Inventors discovered new processes, such as better ways to make steel.

There were several reasons for Britain became the first country to industrialize: First, Britain had a favorable geographical location to participate in European and world trade; it was a country in which the main towns were never too far from seaports, or from rivers, which could distribute their products. Secondly, Britain had political stability and a peaceful society. After the 17th century, it was increasingly interested in overseas trade and colonies. Thirdly, Britain had a good foundation in economy. The limited monarchy which resulted from the Glorious Revolution of 1688 ensured that the powerful economic interests in the community could exert their influence over

Government policy. Fourthly, Britain had many rivers, which were useful for transport but also for water and steam power. Britain also had useful mineral resources. The last reason was that British engineers had skilled craftsmen.

Typical inventions during the Industrial Revolution included:

- John Kay's flying shuttle in 1733;
- James Hargreaves' Spinning Jenny in 1766;
- Richard Arkwright's water frame in 1769;
- Edmund Cartwright's power looms in 1784;
- James Watt's steam engine in 1765.



John Kay's flying shuttle in 1733



The Spinning Jenny, invented in 1764 by James Hargreaves and named after his daughter, was one of the innovations that started the revolution. It made possible the automatic production of cotton thread and revolutionized the textiles industry.



The Victorian era became notorious for the employment of young children in factories and mines and as chimney sweeps. Child labor, often brought about by economic hardship, played an important role in the Industrial Revolution from its initial stage

9. Britain in the Twentieth Century

The 20th century is a period of the decline of Britain as a world power, a period of crises of the two world wars, from which Britain emerged as a victor, but greatly weakened. It is characterised by the disintegration of Britain's colonial empire and the effort to adjust Britain to the new situation by joining the other developed capitalist countries of Western Europe in EEC (European Economic Community).

Britain and the World Wars

The World War I was from 1914 to 1918 primarily between two European Powers: "the Central power" Germany and Austria-Hungary, and the "Allies" Britain, France and Russia. During the war, the Britain lost much. Apart from the loss of manpower, there had been considerable disruption of the economy and society. Out of the war settlement came the establishment of the League of Nations.

An independent Irish free state was created, but six Protestant-dominated counties in the north of Ireland remained under the rule of the United Kingdom. Thus, the Irish Question was partly settled.

In 1929, the shock waves from the New York Stock Market Crash sent Britain into depression and left millions of people out of work, especially in the industrial areas of northern England, south Wales and Scotland.

Newly crowned King Edward VIII decided in 1936 to marry Mrs. Wallis Simpson, an American who had been twice divorced. He was forced to abdicate in the face of opposition from his family, the Church, and the government. The popularity of the monarchy was restored by Edward's brother, George VI.

During the Second World War, as Adolf Hitler and Nazism showed off their aggressive

momentum in Europe, Chamberlain, the Prime Minister, found his policy of appeasement of German aggression was no longer tenable, and was forced to declare war on Germany on September 3, 1939. Cities like Coventry were devastated by bombing, and London was greatly changed by the Blitz.

During the war, most social inequities were set aside. In 1945, when peace was restored, voters hoped that the Labor Party could develop an even greater egalitarianism. The basis of a welfare state was laid, with free medical care provided for everyone; in addition, financial help was provided for the elderly, the sick, and the unemployed.

Emerging from the war with a severely damaged economy, Britain could no longer sustain an empire. Gradually, British colonies became independent.

Postwar Britain

The great social influence of the War meant that Britain were anxious for change. Countless returning soldiers wanted a turn-around in the status quo. Members of British armed forces were considerably better educated than they had been in World War I. The soldier returning from the war resentful of unemployment, wishing for a greater share in the nation's post-war restructuring, and did not trust a Conservative government to tackle the enormous social economic and political problems. As a consequence, Winston Churchill, who led Britain to victory during the war, found himself as a member of the opposition when the election of 1945 returned the Labor Party to power with a huge majority. Under the Parliament of Clement Attlee, the new government began some of the greatest changes in Britain's long history—nothing less than a reconstruction of the nation.

One of the most far-reaching consequences of the War was that it hastened the end of Britain's empire. In 1952 Princess Elizabeth was crowned Queen Elizabeth II. In January 1973, Britain became a full member of the European Economic Community. As Britain entered the 1960s, new universities were built and a reinvigorated culture emerged. While its heavy industry struggled, Britain led the world in fashion and pop music. Inflation and unemployment soared in the 1970s and endless strikes resulted from labor unrest.



Queen Elizabeth II

In 1973 Britain joined the European Community, but there seemed to be few obvious economic benefits. Margaret Thatcher came to power in 1979 and went on to win two

more elections. By 1990 her popularity was so diminished that her party replaced her with John Major, who won the 1992 election. But a reinvigorated Labor Party under Tony Blair won in 1997. The economy remained weak, and Britain continued to distrust the European Community. Nationalism continued to simmer in Scotland and Wales, and conflict continued in Northern Ireland.